government was sceptical and secretly tried to control the outcome of the meeting. Nehru, Sukarno and Nasser played pioneering roles, along with the other Third World leaders, sharing their common problems of resisting the pressures of major powers, maintaining their independence, and opposing colonialism and neo-colonialism as well as western domination. The Conference issued a final communiqué on Economic and Cultural Cooperation, Human Rights and Self-determination following the United Nations Charter which highlighted:

(i) problems of dependent peoples and colonialism,

(ii) ways to promote a new world order based on the principles of respect for fundamental human rights,

(iii) sovereignty and territorial integrity of all nations,

(iv) recognition of the equality of all races and equality of all nations, large and small,

(v) abstention from interference in the internal matters of other countries,

(vi) refraining from acts or threats of aggression or the use of force, and

(vii) promotion of mutual interests and cooperation.

The conference instilled in the participants what came to be recognized as 'the spirit of Bandung'—the recognition of the similarity of purpose and unity of action among oppressed people—to address their common problems and take an active role in changing the existing world order. The final recommendation was that another conference should be held.

First NAM Summit, Belgrade (Yugoslavia), 1–6 September 1961

The spirit of Bandung was carried forward to the Belgrade Summit Conference of 1961. If Bandung was the prelude, the Belgrade Conference marked the official beginning of NAM in the history of international relations. It was attended by 25 participant states and three observer states, all from Latin America, observers from 19 liberation movements, all from Africa, representatives of 11 labour and socialist parties from Europe, Asia and Latin America, and a host of other organizations.